

University of Westminster

School of Computer Science and Engineering

Information Driven Entrepreneurship and Enterprise

Individual Coursework

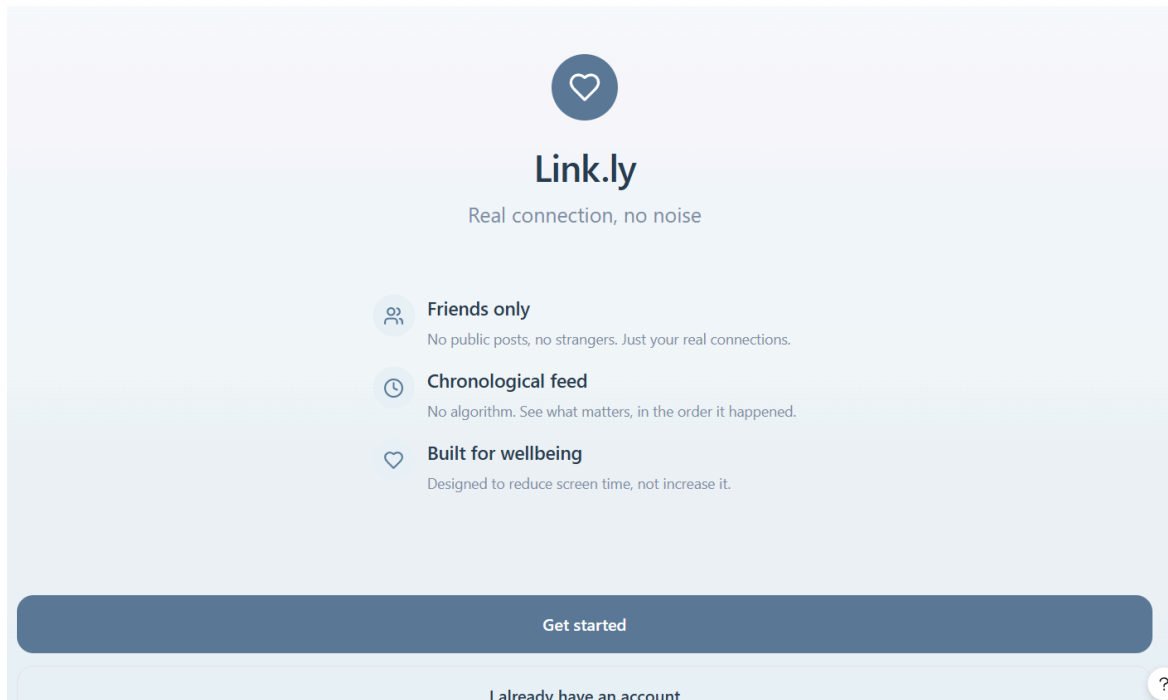
Student name: Ryan Rahman

Student ID: w1967351

Task 1

1b) User Manual

Homepage



This page is the main entry point to the Link.ly platform and provides an overview of its core value proposition, expressed through the tagline “real connection, no noise.” The design reinforces this message by remaining minimal and focused, ensuring users immediately understand the platform’s purpose.

Key platform features are highlighted throughout the page, including friends-only interaction, a chronological feed free from algorithmic influence, and an emphasis on digital wellbeing. These elements differentiate Link.ly from mainstream social media platforms that prioritise engagement-driven design.

The prominent “Get started” button guides users toward the registration process, encouraging onboarding and supporting the subscription-based business model. Overall, this page effectively positions Link.ly as a user-first, wellbeing-focused alternative to traditional ad-driven social networks.

Limitation: Interactive elements like navigation and the “Get started” button aren’t fully functional in this prototype.

Signup page

Create your account

We'll use this to keep you connected

Email address

your@email.com

Phone number (optional)

+1 (555) 000-0000

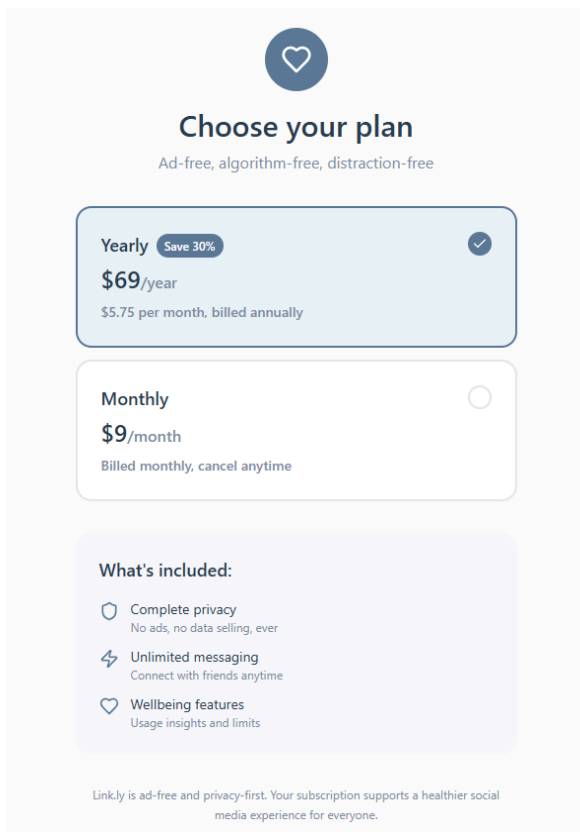
Continue

This page allows new users to sign up to Link.ly and gain access to the platform. Users enter their email address and may optionally include a phone number before selecting “Continue” to move to the next stage of registration.

The minimalistic design supports the business concept by keeping the sign-up experience quick, simple, and free from distractions. This streamlined approach reduces friction during onboarding and encourages users to join efficiently. Fast registration is essential, as users must create an account and begin forming their friend network, which is central to the platform’s value proposition.

Limitation: The prototype doesn’t yet include full account functionality, like password creation, email verification, or age assurance.

Subscription page



The subscription page features a heart icon at the top, followed by the heading "Choose your plan" and the subtext "Ad-free, algorithm-free, distraction-free". Below this, there are two plan options: "Yearly" (selected with a checkmark) and "Monthly". The Yearly plan is priced at \$69/year (\$5.75 per month, billed annually) and includes a "Save 30%" badge. The Monthly plan is priced at \$9/month and is billed monthly, canceling anytime. A section titled "What's included:" lists three benefits: "Complete privacy" (No ads, no data selling, ever), "Unlimited messaging" (Connect with friends anytime), and "Wellbeing features" (Usage insights and limits). At the bottom, a small note states: "Link.ly is ad-free and privacy-first. Your subscription supports a healthier social media experience for everyone."

Choose your plan

Ad-free, algorithm-free, distraction-free

Yearly **Save 30%** ✓

\$69/year

\$5.75 per month, billed annually

Monthly ○

\$9/month

Billed monthly, cancel anytime

What's included:

- Complete privacy
No ads, no data selling, ever
- Unlimited messaging
Connect with friends anytime
- Wellbeing features
Usage insights and limits

Link.ly is ad-free and privacy-first. Your subscription supports a healthier social media experience for everyone.

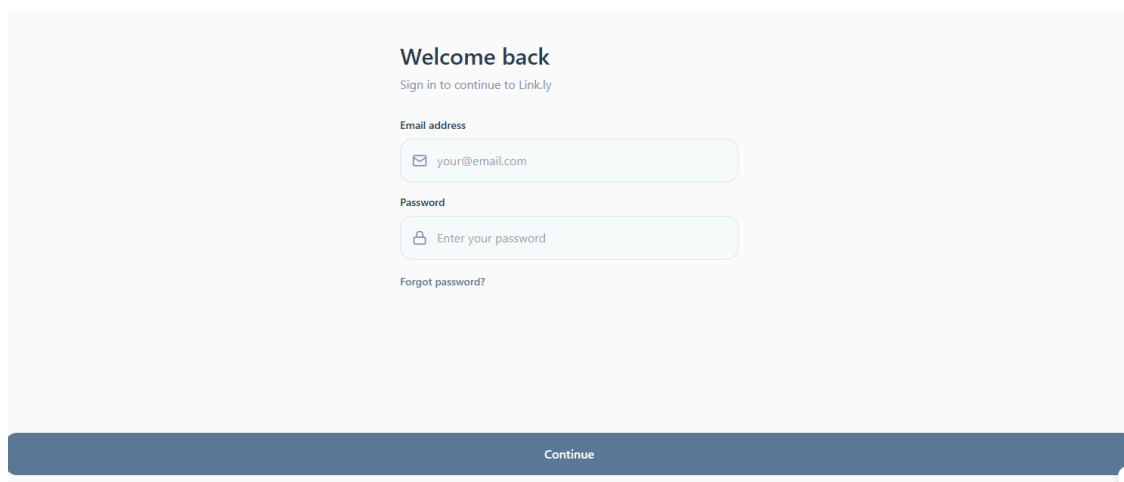
This page enables users to select a subscription plan to access Link.ly. Users can choose between monthly and yearly plans, with the yearly option offered at a discounted rate. Once a plan is selected, users can then proceed to payment.

The interface is intentionally simple, presenting pricing options clearly. This helps users make quick, confident decisions and reduces cognitive load during the subscription process.

This page supports the business model by reinforcing Link.ly's subscription-based approach, where revenue is generated from users rather than advertising. It also highlights key benefits including enhanced privacy, an ad-free experience, and wellbeing-focused features, making the value of the subscription clear.

Limitation: Payment processing and billing functionality aren't included in this prototype.

Login page



The login page has a "Welcome back" heading and a subtext "Sign in to continue to Link.ly". It features two input fields: "Email address" (with a placeholder "your@email.com") and "Password" (with a placeholder "Enter your password"). Below the password field is a link "Forgot password?". At the bottom, there is a blue "Continue" button.

Welcome back

Sign in to continue to Link.ly

Email address

your@email.com

Password

Enter your password

[Forgot password?](#)

Continue

The login page lets existing users access their Link.ly account with email and password. The interface is intentionally simple and minimalistic, allowing users to login quickly without distraction, which aligns with the platform's digital-minimalist design principles.

The inclusion of a “Forgot password?” link enhances usability by providing a clear recovery pathway for users who cannot remember their credentials. This supports accessibility and reduces potential friction during the login process.

This page contributes directly to the business model by ensuring returning users can re-enter the platform efficiently, which is essential for maintaining engagement and retention in a subscription-based service. Reliable and seamless access is a core requirement for sustaining long-term user value.

Limitation: Authentication and password recovery aren’t yet implemented in this prototype.

Create Post Page

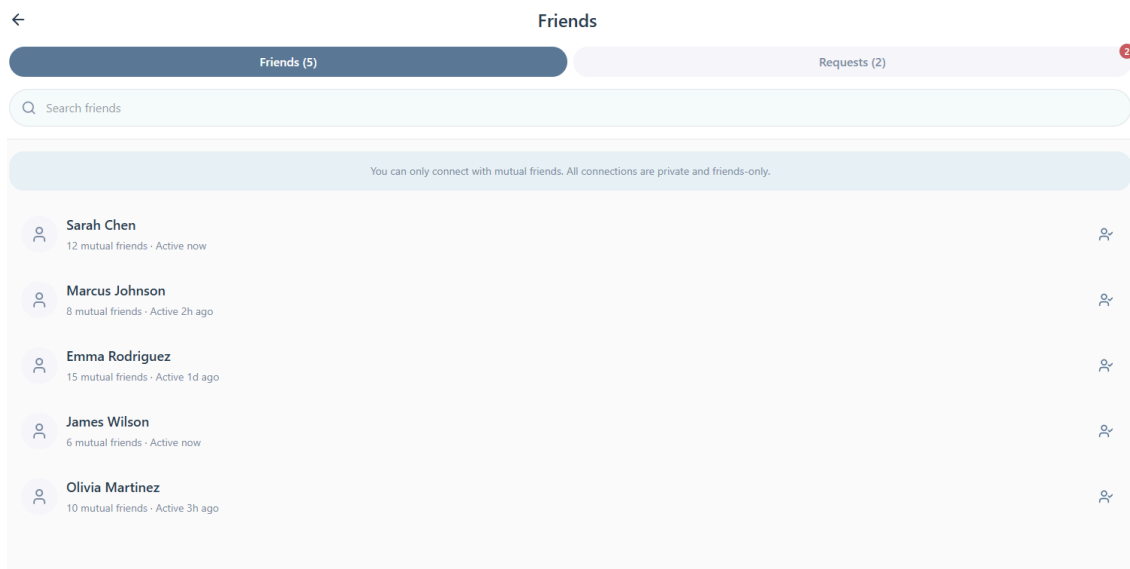
This page allows users to compose a new post that's shared exclusively with their mutual friends on Link.ly. The simple interface features a text box where users can write up to 500 characters. This limit supports Link.ly’s digital-minimalist philosophy by encouraging concise, purposeful sharing rather than frequent posting.

Below the text box, users can see how many posts they created from their five-post daily allowance. This visual indicator reflects the platform’s wellbeing-focused design by reminding users to be intentional with their activity and reducing pressure to post excessively.

A message confirms posts are visible only to friends, reinforcing Link.ly’s commitment to privacy and close-circle communication. When ready, users select the “Post” button to publish content.

Limitation: Posting functionality, quota enforcement, and content submission isn't implemented in this prototype.

Friends page

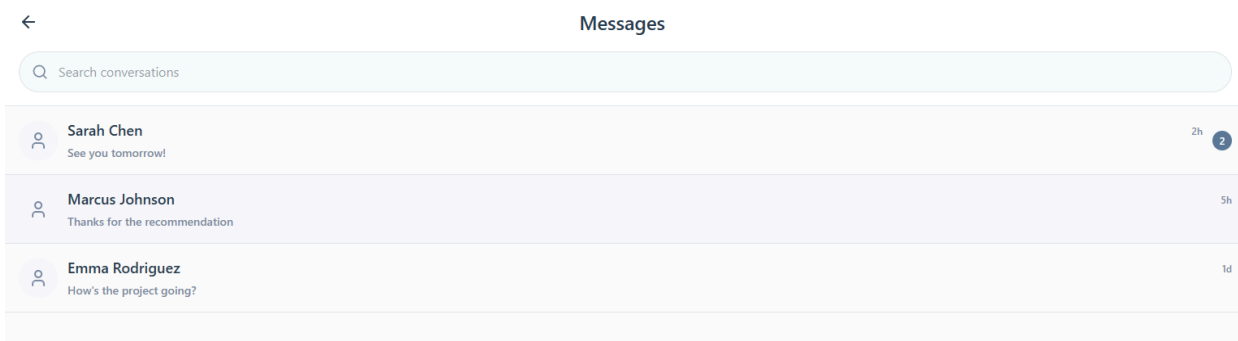


This page lets users manage their friend connections on Link.ly. The interface is simple and minimalistic, reflecting the platform's emphasis on friends-only interaction and purposeful social connection. A search bar at the top allows users to quickly locate specific friends while maintaining a clean, distraction-free design.

The page is divided into two sections: **Friends** and **Requests**. In the Friends tab, accepted connections are displayed with the number of mutual friends and each person's recent activity status, providing useful context while maintaining Link.ly's focus on privacy and mutual-consent connections. A message reinforces that all connections are private and based on mutual acceptance.

Limitation: Friend management actions—such as removing a friend or responding to requests—aren't fully implemented in this prototype.

Messages page



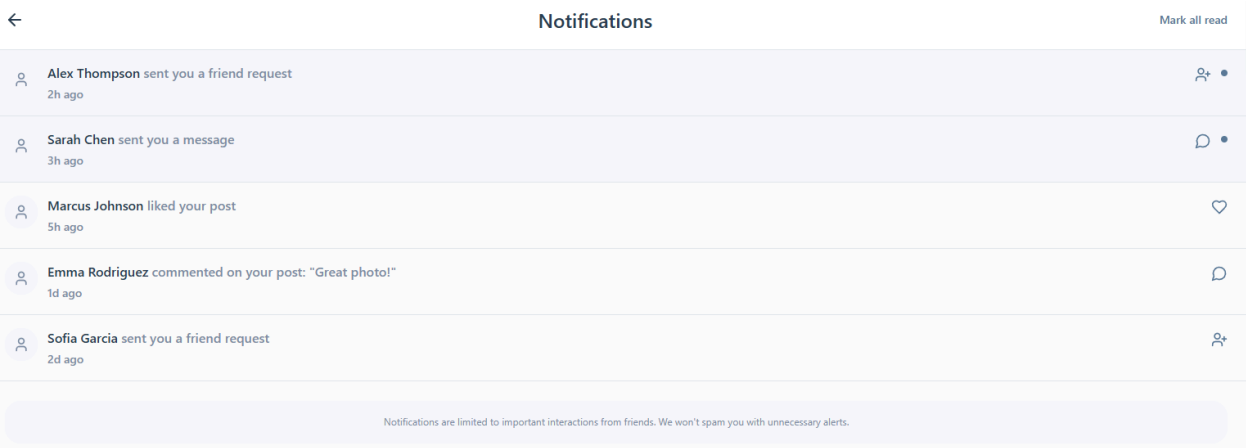
This page lets users manage their recent conversations. The interface is simple and minimalistic, reflecting the platform’s focus on meaningful, friends-only communication. A search bar above lets users quickly locate specific conversations while maintaining a clean, distraction-free experience.

The main section displays recent chats, each showing the friend’s name, message preview, and timestamp. Unread messages are clearly highlighted, ensuring users remain aware of new interactions without overwhelming them with notifications. This design aligns with Link.ly’s wellbeing-focused philosophy by promoting intentional communication rather than attention-driven engagement.

Because Link.ly is built around private, mutual connections, the Messages page plays a central role in sustaining engagement by providing a focused space for direct communication.

Limitation: Real-time messaging functionality, including sending and receiving messages, isn't fully implemented in this prototype.

Notifications page



This page allows users to view important interactions related to their Link.ly account. The interface is simple and minimalistic, reflecting the platform’s focus on meaningful, friends-only engagement rather than attention-driven alerts. Each notification displays the friend’s name, type of interaction, and a timestamp, allowing users to understand recent activity at a glance.

Notifications include events like friend requests, new messages, likes, and comments. Each entry is paired with a small icon that represents the interaction, helping users quickly identify updates without cognitive overload. A short message reinforces that notifications are limited to essential interactions from friends, supporting Link.ly’s commitment to reducing digital noise and promoting intentional communication.

Limitation: Real-time notification functionality, including live updates and interaction handling, isn't fully implemented in this prototype.

Settings page

Settings

Link.ly Premium

Your subscription is active until March 26, 2027

Manage subscription

Privacy & Security

Privacy settings

Control who sees your content

Two-factor authentication

Enabled

Blocked accounts

Manage blocked users

Notifications

Push notifications

Customize alerts

Quiet hours

10:00 PM - 8:00 AM

Wellbeing

Daily usage limit

30 minutes

Screen-free reminders

Enabled

Support

Help center

Get support

Sign out

Link.ly v1.0.0

Terms of Service · Privacy Policy

This page enables users to manage their account preferences, privacy controls, wellbeing features, and subscription settings on Link.ly. The interface is simple and well-structured, reflecting the platform’s digital-minimalist approach and allowing users to navigate their options efficiently.

At the top, users can view their Link.ly Premium subscription status, including the renewal date and plan management. The Privacy & Security section allows users to adjust who can see their content, manage blocked accounts, and check 2FA, supporting privacy and account security.

users customise alerts and set quiet hours, while the Wellbeing section includes tools like daily usage limits and screen-free reminders. The Support section provides access to the help centre, and a sign-out option and policy links.

Limitation: Subscription management and real-time wellbeing features aren’t fully functional in this prototype.

Activities page

Local Activities

Discover real-world activities in your area

Your location: San Francisco

Activities are curated to encourage real-world connection, not more screen time.

Wellness

Community Yoga in the Park

Central Park

Tomorrow, 9:00 AM

12 people interested

View details

Community

Local Farmers Market

Downtown Square

Saturday, 8:00 AM

45 people interested

View details

Culture

Book Club Meetup

City Library

Next Monday, 6:00 PM

8 people interested

View details

The Notifications section lets

the interface is simple and

wellbeing features, and

subscription settings on Link.ly.

The interface is simple and

well-structured, reflecting the

platform’s digital-minimalist

approach and allowing users to

navigate their options efficiently.

At the top, users can view their

Link.ly Premium subscription

status, including the renewal

date and plan management. The

Privacy & Security section

allows users to adjust who can

see their content, manage

This page helps users find real-life activities in their local area, supporting Link.ly’s philosophy of encouraging meaningful offline connections rather than increasing screen time. The layout is simple, with the user’s location shown at the top and a note explaining that activities are curated to promote real-world interaction.

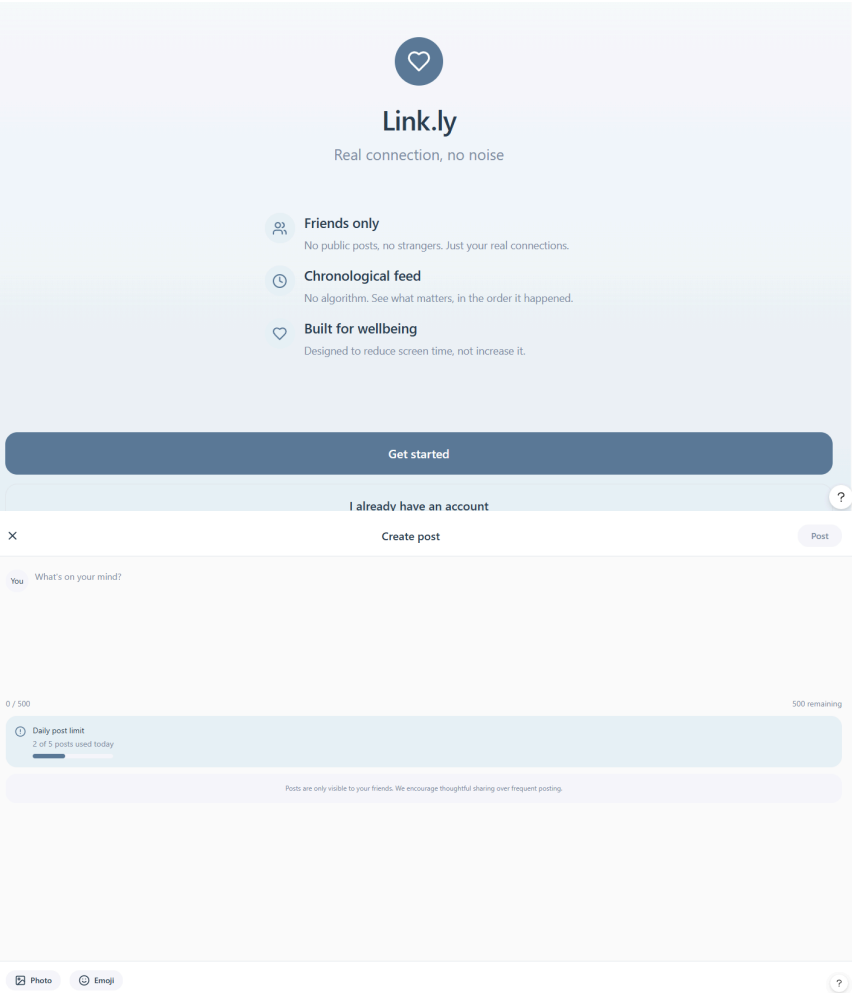
The main section lists upcoming activities, each presented with a category label, title, location, time, and number of people interested. This format allows users to quickly understand each activity and decide whether it appeals to them. A “View details” option for each activity, enabling users to explore further without overload.

The activities shown—including wellness sessions, markets, and cultural meetups—are community-based and reinforce Link.ly’s aim to support healthy, intentional social habits.

Limitation: Event details, live availability, and real-time location-based recommendations aren’t incorporated in this prototype.

Task 2

1) Porters Five Forces



Threat of New Entrants: Moderate
Building a platform is no longer the difficult part, AI coding assistants can make developers around 21% faster (Nguyen & Nadi, 2024). The harder part is getting attention and keeping people active, because users rely on dominant platforms daily, with WhatsApp being used by 80% of internet users and Instagram by 39% (Ofcom, 2024). This means people test new apps while using existing ones, which eases launching and competing for the same attention. Link.ly can reduce this risk by focusing on niche users who want a non-algorithmic, wellbeing-focused experience. Building strong community norms and user loyalty will make switching costs less attractive.

Rivalry Among Existing Competitors: High
Biggest platforms can copy popular ideas quickly (Meta's Facebook Friends tab shows only friends' content), and competition is also for attention and discovery. SpaceHey shows there is demand for a simpler, friends-first experience, but its UK shutdown highlights that regulation and safety duties can limit which similar services can operate in this market (SpaceHey, 2025). Rather than competing for mass adoption, Link.ly will target a specific audience, prioritising safety and compliance from launch can also build trust as an advantage.

Threat of Substitute Products: Moderate
Many people already achieve the same outcomes (chatting privately, sharing with a close circle, finding communities, and discovering local updates) using free alternatives. WhatsApp alone has 3B+ monthly users, making it a strong substitute, while Instagram's Close Friends feature and community spaces like Discord/Reddit cover other features (TechCrunch, 2025). Link.ly's opportunity is to reduce friction, so users don't have to manage multiple apps. Link.ly can reduce substitution combining chronological feed and posting limits to create an experience that mainstream platforms don't offer.

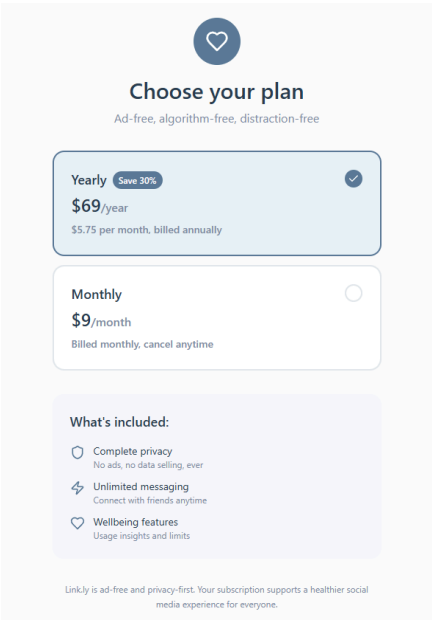
Bargaining Power of Buyers: High
Consumers can meet needs using free and familiar services, so switching costs are low. Charging a subscription in a market conditioned to free social products increases price pressure and churn risk. However, for Link.ly's users, willingness to pay can be higher if the product delivers a wellbeing benefit after free trial/first renewal, which'll help showcase value before subscription commitment.

Bargaining Power of Supplier: Moderate
The web app mainly depends on hosting and payment providers, which are usually easy to switch, but the mobile app will later add reliance on Apple/Google distribution and payment rules (Apple Developer, n.d.; Google, n.d.). To mitigate, we'll start with web subscriptions and keep more than one payment option, which reduces dependence on a single supplier.

In the group coursework, the Five Forces analysis highlighted intense competition and strong substitutes, as users already rely on free platforms such as **WhatsApp** and **Instagram**. The strategic response was to differentiate through digital minimalism, a chronological feed, and the removal of engagement-driven algorithms, positioning Link.ly as a wellbeing-focused alternative rather than a direct competitor.

This strategy is directly reflected in my prototype through the design of the **Homepage** and **Create Post** pages. On the homepage, Link.ly is introduced with the tagline “*real connection, no noise,*” and the feed is described as chronological and friends-only, reinforcing the non-algorithmic experience identified in the strategic analysis. On the Create Post page, minimalism is further embedded through a 500-character limit and a five-posts-per-day quota, reducing pressure to overshare and preventing infinite-scroll behaviours. These design choices operationalise the strategic decision and create competitive advantage by reducing mental overload compared to algorithm-driven platforms like Instagram, allowing Link.ly to compete on intentionality and wellbeing rather than attention capture. However, this may reduce engagement compared to algorithm-driven platforms.

2) SWOT Analysis

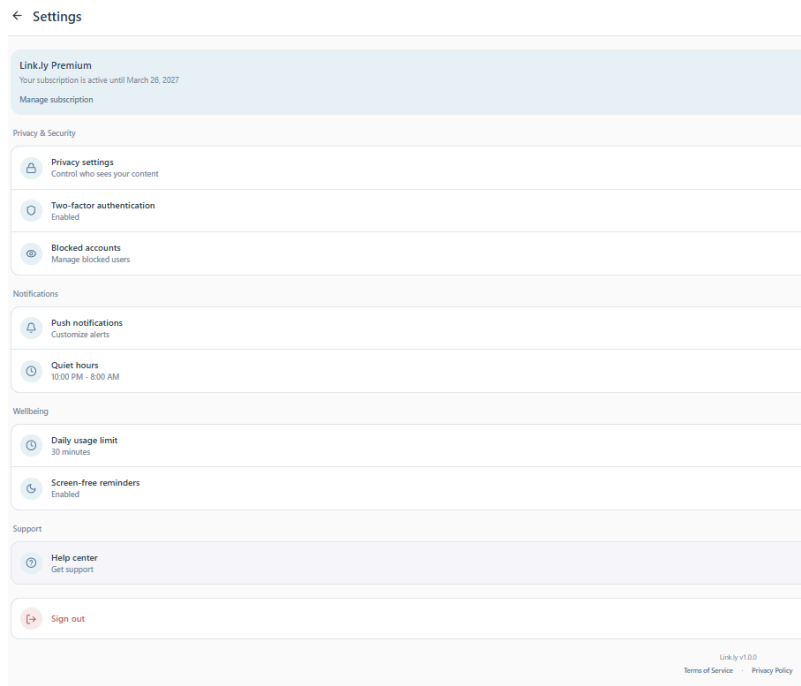


Our Organisation (Link.ly)	Strengths 1. Position as a minimalist app 2. No algorithms = reducing spread of misinformation 3. Subscription-based model	Weaknesses 1. Subscriptions limit quick user acquisition 2. Low brand recognition 3. Little value until friend network increases
Opportunities 1. Market for digital minimalism apps 2. Distrust and privacy issues between existing platforms 3. Partnerships with universities and well-being organisations	SO strategies Heavily position and market non-algorithmic feed to engage new digitally minimalist users (S2,O1) Reinvesting revenue from partnerships to create discounted packages for students (S3,O3)	WO strategies Providing free trials to encourage adoption (S1,O1) partnerships with universities to create word-of-mouth interactions for awareness and recognition (W2,O3)
Threats 1. Large competitors imitating features 2. Price-sensitive consumers due to economic pressure 3. Slow adoption	ST strategies Create differentiation through strong identity based on values to minimise imitation by competitors (S1,T1)	WT strategies Invest and create strong brand to position as original digital minimalist platform before competitors (W2,T1)

The SWOT analysis identified the subscription-based model as a key strength because it aligns revenue with user wellbeing rather than attention-seeking behaviour. This differentiates Link.ly from competitors that rely on advertising and algorithmic engagement, reinforcing the platform's ethical positioning.

This strategic decision is reflected in my prototype through the design of the **Subscription Page**, where users can choose between monthly and discounted yearly plans. The page emphasises benefits highlighted in the group coursework, including enhanced privacy, an ad-free experience, and wellbeing-focused features. By presenting these options clearly and without upselling, the interface operationalises the strategic aim of offering a transparent, user-first business model. However, subscription fees may discourage users used to free platforms.

3) PESTEL Analysis



The PESTEL analysis highlighted the strict regulatory environment in the UK, particularly the requirements for age assurance, content moderation, and safety-by-design principles under the Online Safety Act. The group coursework emphasised that long-term viability depends on meeting these obligations, as non-compliance creates legal, financial, and reputational risks.

This strategic priority is reflected in my prototype through the **Settings Page**, which includes dedicated sections for **Privacy & Security**, **blocked accounts**, and **2FA**. These features address the legal need for user protection, data minimisation, and account integrity. The prototype also clearly states limitations, noting that full moderation, authentication, and safety mechanisms will be implemented in the final system. This demonstrates how regulatory analysis shaped the design by ensuring that compliance and

Political

UK online safety act 2023 regulations ensure social platforms implement strong content moderation for user-to-user services, even with a friend-first design, because users can connect with strangers sharing harmful content through posts and messaging. From July 2025, online services have a legal duty, protecting children online and must use effective age assurance to access content (UK Government, 2023). This raises ongoing operating costs and creates reputational risk if controls fail, so the business needs clear governance and documented safety processes. The startup may be eligible for UK innovation finance (UK Innovation Loans), but funding is competitive and uncertain (Innovate UK, 2025). There is large political scrutiny over algorithmic ranking systems determining the content being presented. Governments are therefore trying to regulate and reduce misinformation conforming to regulatory standards.

7

Economic

UK household budgets remain constrained by inflationary pressures creating caution about purchasing another subscription to price sensitive customers (House of Commons, 2026). UK consumers frequently cancel subscriptions, and competition reduces customers' willingness to pay £2.99 for apps providing similar features. Customers are likely to cancel a minimum one service within 12 months, so pricing must stay simple and clearly justified (Barclays, 2025; YouGov, 2024). Opportunities involve yearly subscriptions providing businesses with stable income rather than ads which are economically unpredictable due to high volatility and changing algorithms. Nowadays customers are accustomed to having to purchase a subscription for any new service therefore it is not a surprise that this service will come at a cost as it is more exclusive rather than a saturated free app used by anyone. The community feature poses an opportunity and will help boost revenue as more people will talk about how easy it is to connect with others making them feel comfortable. This encourages more people to purchase the subscription.

Socio-cultural

Socio-cultural conditions support private social platforms centred on close connections. GEN Z Concerns show 45% worried over digital addiction with 87% having negative impacts on mental health. Interest in predictable, non-recommended feeds is visible in major platforms experimenting with friend-only experiences (Meta, 2025). However, new platforms face challenges as they have little value if existing friends don't adopt as many still value public performance metrics (views, likes). 68% of expats say it is difficult building a new social group therefore our community feature reduces this by connecting through activities and interest with others. Within society word of mouth has huge impacts on the popularity of new apps.

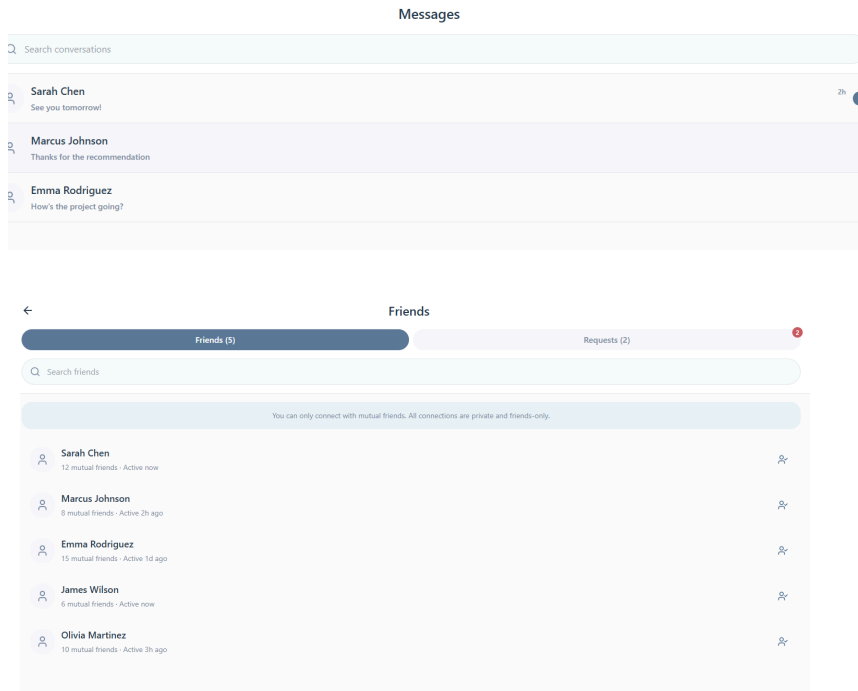
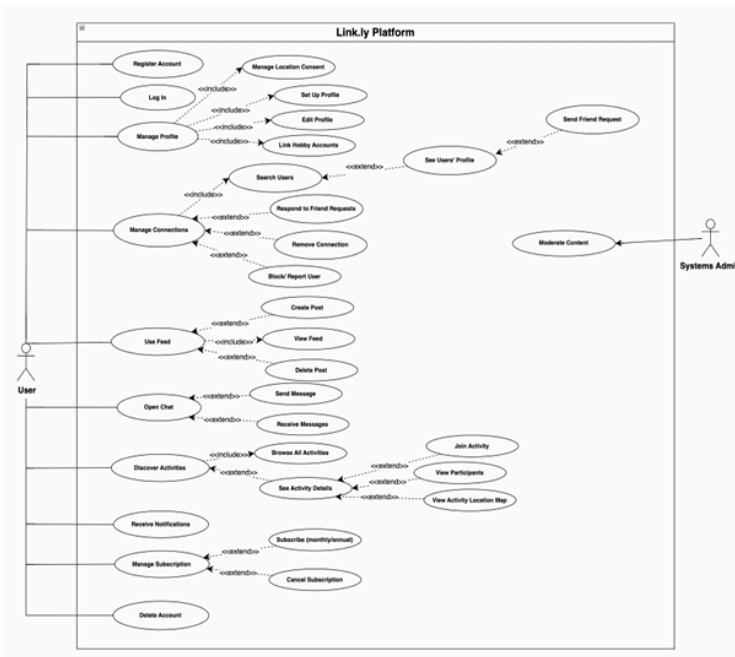
Technological

Products require safety-by-default engineering because abuse occurs through posts, private messaging. MVP priorities are account integrity and rate limiting, reporting, moderation, and messaging protections to reduce harassment and unwanted contact (Instagram, 2021; Discord, n.d.).

Next-stage priorities include automated filtering and review triage to scale enforcement (Reddit, 2026). UK compliance makes age assurance and children's access assessments central to onboarding and feature design (Ofcom, 2024). Low technological barriers allow large competitors to imitate apps using technology available to everyone. Moreover listing apps (app store, google play) involves commission to providers (15%-30%) reducing profit. Scalable cloud computing systems such as AWS are required to host the system providing a reliable service through secure data storage and

user safety are embedded into the platform's core structure. However, implementing these features may increase development costs and technical complexity.

4) Use Case Model



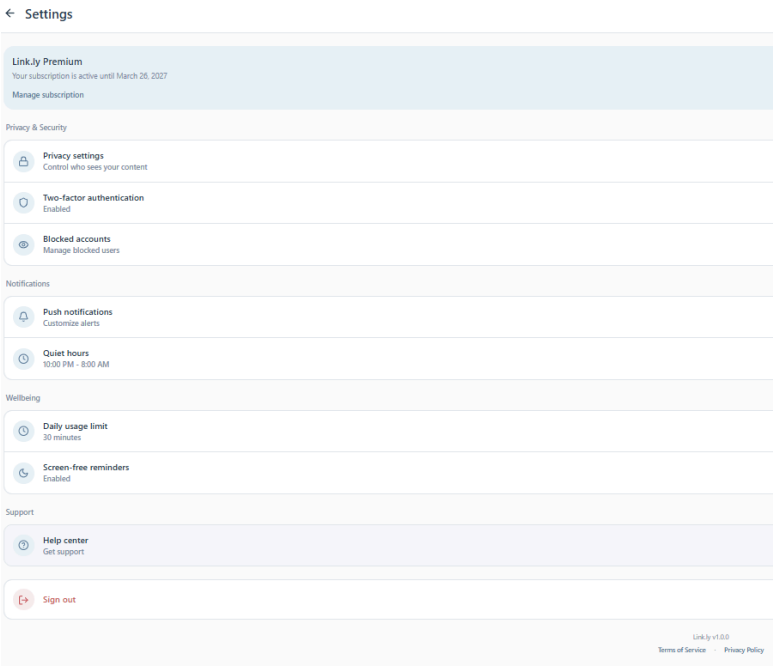
The group coursework's use-case model identified Manage Connections, Send Messages, and View Feed as essential functional requirements, each classified as "High" or "Critical" in the functional requirements table. These use cases form the core of Link.ly's friend-only interaction model, reflecting the strategic decision to prioritise meaningful, private communication over public broadcasting.

This is directly implemented in my prototype through the Friends Page, Messages Page, and Notifications Page. The Friends Page includes a search bar, mutual-friend indicators, and a dedicated requests section, supporting the mutual-acceptance model outlined in the system design. The Messages Page displays recent chats, previews, timestamps, and unread indicators, enabling focused one-to-one communication. The Notifications Page highlights friend requests, likes, comments, and messages, ensuring users remain aware of essential interactions without algorithmic noise.

Together, these pages operationalise the system-level design by translating the core use cases into clear, minimalistic interfaces that support Link.ly's friend-first philosophy. Nonetheless, friends-only interaction may limit user growth and content discovery.

5) Lean Canvas

Customers' top problems: 1) Algorithm-driven, privacy exploitation on ad-funded platforms 2) Fragmented connections during life transitions Existing Alternatives: Meta/Facebook, MeWe, SpaceHey (not available in the UK)	Possible solutions for each problem: 1) Strict usage limits (1 post/day, 5/week) 2) Friend-only chronological feed Key Metrics: - renewal % - retention - average # of mutual connections after 7 days	Unique Value Proposition: Stay close without noise by enabling real connection in a friend-first social space High-Level Concept: 2007 Facebook meets the loud and distracting digital age; WhatsApp/Messenger/Signal combined MeetUp, without algorithmic manipulation	Unfair Advantage: First UK-compliant minimalist platform following SpaceHey's withdrawal. Direct London university access for cost effective acquisition. Channels and path to customers (acquisition): University partnerships, wellbeing organisations, word-of-mouth within friend networks and digital minimalist communities	Customer Segments: UK students and young professionals experiencing relocation/study abroad; privacy conscious digital minimalists Early Adopters: Students studying abroad; remote workers relocating to new cities, digital detox/wellbeing community participants
Cost Structure: Costs include cloud infrastructure, age verification compliance, payment processing, marketing, and moderation			Revenue Structure: Monthly: £2.99. Annual: £23.88 (33% discount). Model: Direct subscription.	



According to Lean Canvas, Link.ly’s unique value proposition was “*Stay close without noise by enabling real connection in a friend-first social space.*” The Canvas also identified strict usage limits, non-algorithmic feeds, and wellbeing tools as key solutions that differentiate the platform from attention-driven competitors.

These strategic decisions are reflected in my prototype through the **Wellbeing section** of the Settings page and the **Create Post** page. The Settings page includes **daily usage limits** and **screen-free reminders**, directly supporting the wellbeing-focused strategy outlined in the Canvas. The Create Post page enforces **strict posting limits**, encouraging intentional communication and preventing the excessive posting behaviours associated with algorithmic platforms. Together, these features operationalise the Lean Canvas solutions by embedding digital minimalism and user wellbeing into the core design of the prototype. However, strict limits may frustrate highly active users and reduce engagement.

Conclusion

Across all five examples, the prototype clearly reflects the strategic and systems-level decisions established in the group coursework. The design choices — from subscription transparency to wellbeing tools and privacy controls — demonstrate how Link.ly’s core philosophy has been translated into practical interface decisions. This alignment shows that the prototype is not just a collection of pages, but a coherent implementation of the platform’s strategic positioning in a competitive market. Overall, the prototype effectively implements the group’s vision of a friend-first, minimalist, and wellbeing-focused social platform.

Task 3

An appropriate cloud computing solution for implementing Link.ly is Amazon Web Services (AWS), using a combination of AWS Amplify (PaaS) for hosting the front end and Amazon DynamoDB (NoSQL) for data storage. This combination is well-suited because it provides scalability, robust security, and rapid development without the overhead of managing physical infrastructure.

AWS Amplify is a Platform-as-a-Service that offers hosting, authentication, APIs, and storage for web and mobile applications. This aligns with Link.ly's requirements as a cloud-based social platform that must scale alongside its growing user base. Amplify integrates with AWS Cognito, which provides secure sign-in, multi-factor authentication, and account recovery. These features directly support the privacy and safety requirements highlighted in the group coursework, particularly the need for strong identity verification and compliance with UK regulations such as GDPR and the Online Safety Act.

Amazon DynamoDB is a fully managed NoSQL database service capable of handling large volumes of data with low latency. Social networking platforms rely heavily on fast read/write operations for posts, messages, notifications, and friend connections. DynamoDB's automatic scaling and high throughput make it suitable for meeting the non-functional requirement from the coursework, which specifies support for up to 50,000 concurrent users.

Integrating AWS into Link.ly would follow a clear architecture. The current prototype front end (built in Google Sites and Figma) would be replaced by a React or Next.js interface deployed through Amplify. User authentication would be managed by Cognito, while all user-generated content would be stored in DynamoDB tables. AWS Lambda could handle notifications, enforce posting limits, and support moderation workflows. This serverless approach reduces operational overhead, as AWS automatically manages scaling, availability, and maintenance.

From a cost perspective, AWS offers a pay-as-you-go pricing model, which is ideal for a startup. Amplify and DynamoDB include free tiers, enabling early development and testing at minimal cost. Traditional on-premises infrastructure, in contrast, requires significant upfront investment in servers, networking, and maintenance staff. However, cloud costs can become unpredictable during usage spikes, so monitoring tools such as AWS Cost Explorer would be necessary to manage and control spending.

Security is a major advantage of AWS. The platform provides encryption at rest and in transit, DDoS protection, identity and access management, and compliance with standards including GDPR, ISO 27001, and SOC 2. For a privacy-first platform like Link.ly, these protections enhance user trust and reduce the risk of data breaches. Managing these controls manually in a traditional infrastructure would be unrealistic for a small startup.

There are, however, some disadvantages. Vendor lock-in can make migrating to another provider difficult once the system is built around AWS services. Although AWS is highly reliable, outages can still occur, making Link.ly dependent on Amazon's uptime. Additionally, serverless

architectures can introduce complexity in debugging and monitoring, requiring developers to understand distributed systems.

Despite these drawbacks, AWS remains a strong fit for Link.ly because it directly supports the company's strategic priorities. The group coursework emphasised the importance of scalability, safety-by-design, privacy, and cost-efficient growth. AWS provides all of these through managed services, automated scaling, and robust security. It also supports Link.ly's long-term vision of expanding from a web-only MVP to a mobile app, as Amplify integrates seamlessly with iOS and Android development.

Overall, AWS offers a practical and reliable cloud solution that enhances Link.ly's technical implementation while supporting its business processes. By leveraging Amplify, Cognito, DynamoDB, and Lambda, Link.ly can provide a secure, scalable, and privacy-oriented social platform without managing physical infrastructure. This approach closely aligns with the strategic analysis and system design decisions outlined in the group coursework.

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I declare that I have used Figma as a design and prototyping tool in the creation of this coursework.